

The Cultural Continuum from Folk to Popular Culture (Folk culture/popular culture differences)

Folk Culture	Popular Culture
Subsistence-for own use	Commercial-For Sale
Dependent upon local environment/resources	Dependent on global environment/resources
Non-industrialized, low technology/low energy	Industrialized/high technology/high energy
Lower impact on environment	Higher impact on environment
Regional self-sufficiency/subsistence	Regional specialization/commercial
Geographic isolation/slow diffusion or change	Communication/transportation/rapid diffusion
Non-Standardized, no two identical	Standardized/mass produced
Low cultural diversity within folk culture group	High cultural diversity within popular culture group
Folk culture landscapes-regionally unique	Popular culture landscapes-standardized
Relationship between folk culture and ethnicity Ethnicity and social customs Ethnicity, race and racism	Frequent decreases in ethnic visibility Popular culture conversion of ethnicity Loss of ethnic identity
Modern patterns and processes of folk culture	Modern patterns and processes of popular culture
Demise of folk cultures resulting from diffusion of technology.	Expansion of popular culture in global pursuit of higher standard of living.

CULTURES EXIST ALONG A CONTINUUM FROM POPULAR TO FOLK WHICH IS ALSO A CONTINUUM SO-----THERE IS PROBABLY NO PURE FOLK CULTURES TODAY.

Origins of Folk Culture

Tradition-Folk culture is deeply rooted in tradition. It comes from the past. Things are done the way they were done in the past.

Rural or isolated indigenous communities-Folk culture is found in rural or isolated areas. The more isolated an area is, the less it has been impacted from the diffusion of popular culture.

Origins of Popular Culture

Urban-Popular culture typically originates in urban areas and spreads from there.

Changeable- Popular culture can change. It can be localized for a particular culture (**glocalization**) or change over time.

Media Influence – The media has helped accelerate the spread of popular culture.